



▲ GREAT TURKISH BOMBARD

Date 1464

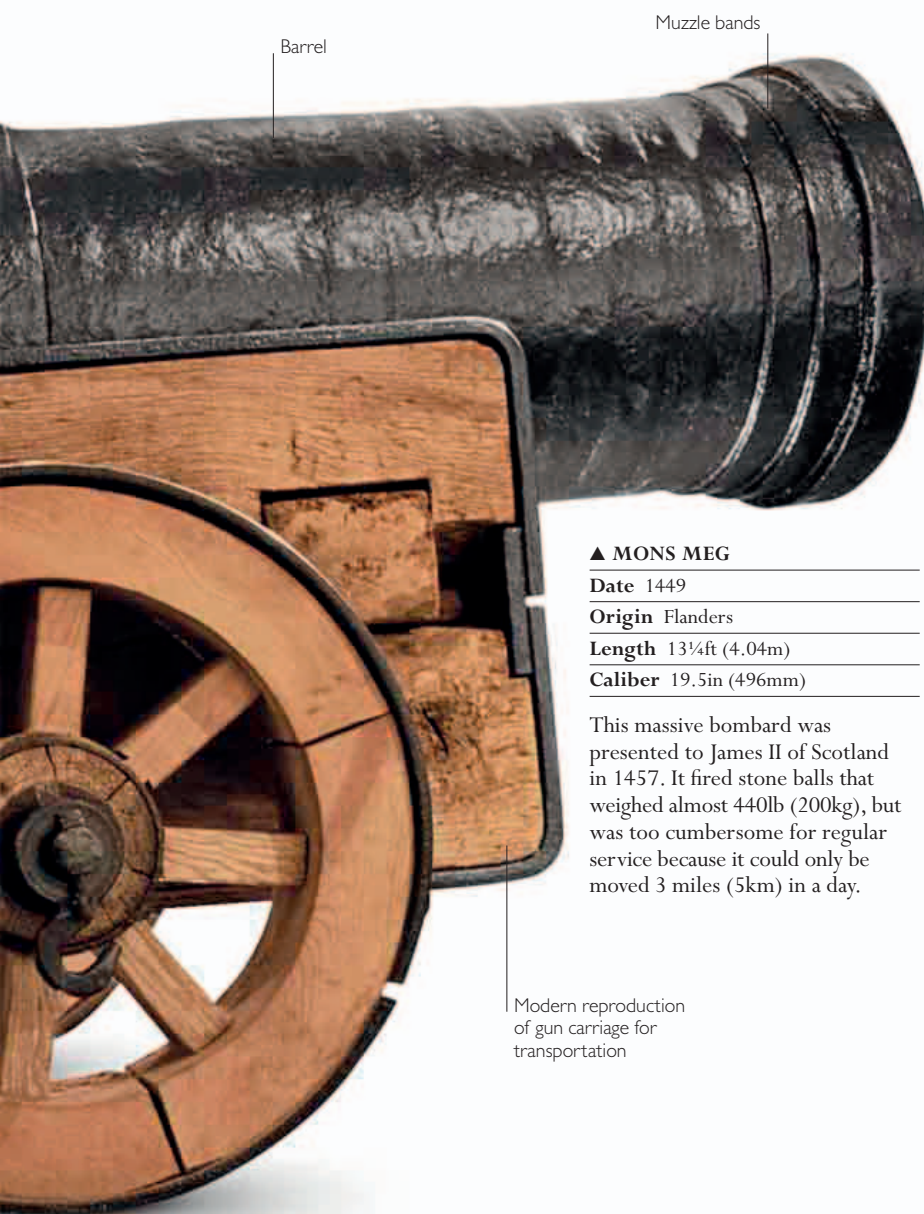
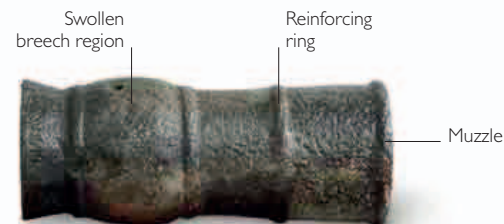
Origin Turkey

Length (Barrel) 11½ft (3.5m)

Caliber 25in (635mm)

Cast in bronze, this remarkable weapon was built to defend the Dardanelles, the narrow strait connecting the Sea of Marmara with the Aegean Sea. It was made in two parts, either so the gun could be moved, or perhaps to place the powder charge in the breech, making it an enormous early breech-loader. The barrel of the gun is seen here. Together with its breech section, this bombard would have been more than 16½ft (5m) long.

Astragals (decorative moldings)



Muzzle bands

Barrel

▲ CHINESE IRON CANNON

Date c.1500

Origin China

Length 1½ft (0.47m)

Caliber 4in (100mm)

This small cannon was fired from a trestlelike stand. It was cast with a bulbous breech region to resist pressure. Rather than firing a single projectile, it was loaded with a number of smaller missiles.

Wide muzzle

Fixing ring to attach to carriage



▲ MONS MEG

Date 1449

Origin Flanders

Length 13¼ft (4.04m)

Caliber 19.5in (496mm)

This massive bombard was presented to James II of Scotland in 1457. It fired stone balls that weighed almost 440lb (200kg), but was too cumbersome for regular service because it could only be moved 3 miles (5km) in a day.

Modern reproduction of gun carriage for transportation

▲ EARLY MORTAR

Date 15th–16th century

Origin England

Length 4ft (1.2m)

Caliber 14.2in (360mm)

A mortar was a muzzle-loading siege gun that fired projectiles such as stones or perhaps incendiaries at high angles over the walls of fortifications. This mortar was found in the moat of Bodiam Castle, England. It is pictured here in a resting state at a low angle.